The external outputs can be data like metrics, logs, and traces. Figure 1.6 shows how observability works.

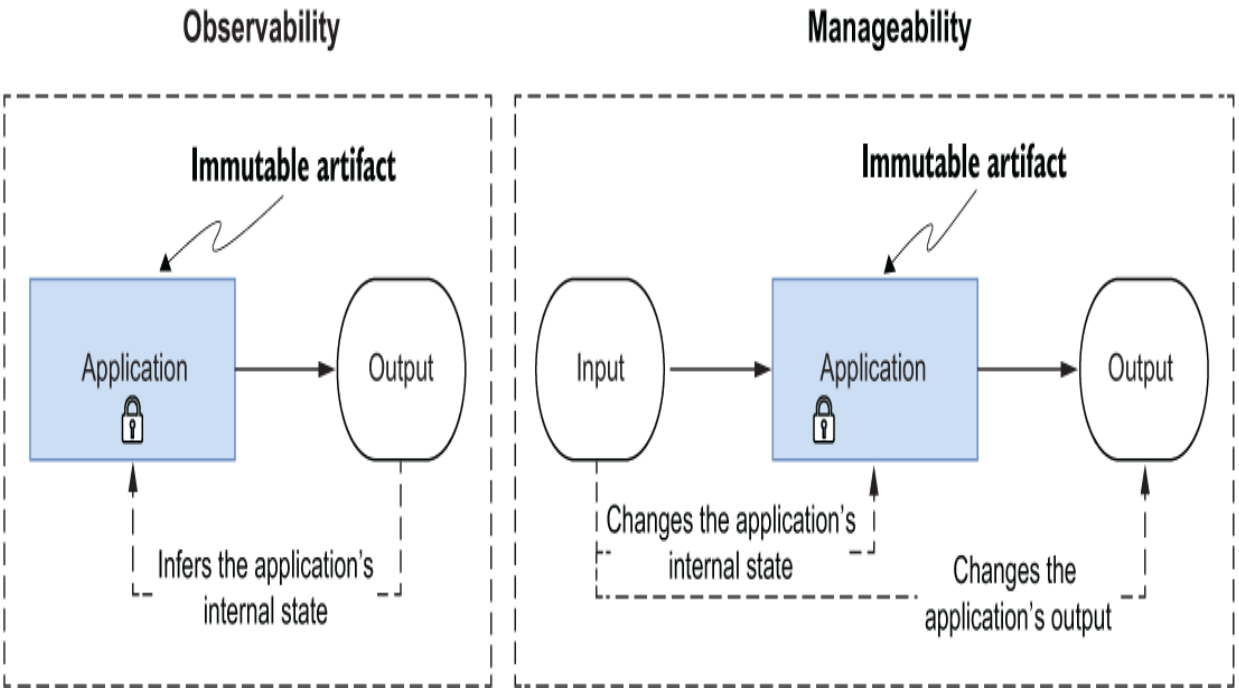


Figure 1.6 Observability is about inferring the internal state of an application from its external outputs. Manageability is about changing the internal state and outputs via external inputs. In both cases, the application artifact is never changed. It's immutable.

The Observability Engineering team at Twitter identifies four pillars of observability:[9]

- *Monitoring*—Monitoring is about measuring specific aspects of an application to get information on its overall health and identify failures. In this book, you'll learn about the useful monitoring features of Spring Boot Actuator and integrate Prometheus with Spring to export relevant metrics about an application.